

Candace E. Jens

CONTACT INFORMATION

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Finance, University of Rochester, 2013.
MSBA, Applied Economics, University of Rochester, 2011.
Niagara University, B.A., Political Science, summa cum laude, 2008.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Syracuse University: Associate Professor, May 2026 – present.
Syracuse University: Assistant Professor, August 2022 – May 2026.
Tulane University: Assistant Professor, July 2015 – June 2022.
Tulane University: Visiting Assistant Professor, July 2013 – June 2015.

PUBLICATIONS

“Balancing External vs. Internal Validity: An Application of Causal Forest in Finance,”
(with Huseyin Gulen and T. Beau Page), *Management Science*, 72 (2026): 3454–3486.

“Credit Cycles, Expectations, and Corporate Investment,” (with Huseyin Gulen, Mihai Ion,
and Stefano Rossi), *Review of Financial Studies*, 37 (2024): 3335–3385.

“Uncertainty, Precautionary Saving, and Investment: Evidence from Pre-scheduled Election
Cycles,” (with T. Beau Page), *Financial Management* 53 (2024): 431–470. (lead article)

“Political Uncertainty and Firm Investment: Project-level Evidence from M&A Activity”
(with Zhenhua Chen, Mehmet Cihan, and T. Beau Page), *Journal of Financial and
Quantitative Analysis* 58 (2023): 71–103.

“Political Uncertainty and Investment: Causal Evidence from U.S. Gubernatorial
Elections,” *Journal of Financial Economics* 124 (2017): 563–579.

“The Real Effects of Delisting: Evidence from a Regression Discontinuity Design,”
(with Tor-Erik Bakke and Toni Whited) *Finance Research Letters* 9 (2012): 183–193.

Winner of the 2012 Ross Prize for Best Paper.

WORKING PAPERS

“Credit Market Driven Acquisitions,” (with Huseyin Gulen and Stefano Rossi), November 2025.

Winner of “Best Paper in Finance” Award, FMARC Conference, 2024.

2022 SFS Cavalcade, 2023 American Finance Association, 2024 FMARC Conference.

“Controlling for Group-level Heterogeneity in Causal Forest,” (with T. Beau Page and James Reeder, III), July 2025.

“Change in Capitol: How a 60 Minutes Exposé and the STOCK Act Affected the Investment Activity of U.S. Senators” (with Ian Cherry and Amanda Heitz), October 2018.

2017 Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting, 2018 European Finance Association.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Explaining the (Re-)Emergence of the Diversification Discount” (with Huseyin Gulen and T. Beau Page).

HONORS AND AWARDS

Gutttag Junior Faculty Research Fellowship Award, Martin J. Whitman School of Management, 2025.

“Best Paper in Finance” Award, FMARC Conference, 2024.

Dean’s Excellence in Teaching Award for Undergraduate Education, 2021.

Dean’s Excellence in Teaching Award for Undergraduate Education, 2016.

Beta Gamma Sigma, 2013.

Ross Prize for the Best Paper in *Finance Research Letters*, 2012.

William E. Simon School Teaching Honor Roll, Summer 2012.

William E. Simon School Doctoral Fellowship, 2008 – 2013.

Niagara University Senior Medal (Valedictorian), 2008.

GRANTS

Recipient of an Altman Program in International Studies & Business grant, Fall 2017.

Recipient of a Tulane Faculty Networking Seminar grant, Spring 2017.

Recipient of an Undergraduate Activities Fund grant to fund in-class market simulation, Spring 2021.

SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- 2023 Syracuse University (brown bag).
- 2022 Syracuse University.
- 2021 University of Iowa.
- 2020 Tulane University (brown bag).
- 2018 Georgia State University.
- 2017 Tulane University (brown bag).
- 2016 Tulane University (brown bag).
- 2014 Tulane University, University of Pittsburgh, Syracuse University, University of Cincinnati.
- 2013 Washington University in St. Louis, Purdue University, Southern Methodist University.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

CONFERENCE PROGRAM COMMITTEE

Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting (2018)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2023 American Finance Association, Craig Holden Memorial Finance Conference (2022),
2022 American Finance Association, 2020 Young Scholars Finance Conference,
2020 Northeastern University Finance Conference, 2020 Eastern Finance Association
(cancelled), New Technologies in Finance Conference (2019), Conference on
Financial Economics and Accounting (2017), Financial Management Association
Doctoral Student Consortium (2012).

CONFERENCE DISCUSSANT

Western Finance Association (2016), Northern Finance Association (2017), Financial
Management Association (2017, 2018, 2022).

CONFERENCE SESSION CHAIR

Financial Management Association (2018), Conference on Financial Economics and
Accounting (2018).

CONFERENCE SERIES ORGANIZER

Tulane University seminar series co-organizer (Fall 2019, Spring 2020), Tulane
University Zoom seminar series organizer (Spring 2020, Summer 2020).

REFEREE

Journal of Financial Economics, Journal of International Business Studies, Finance Research Letters, Journal of Banking and Finance, Journal of Economics and Business, Review of Financial Studies, American Economic Review: Insights, Global Finance Journal, Economic Journal, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Empirical Finance, Journal of Corporate Finance, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Journal of Financial Stability, Management Science, Journal of Financial Intermediation, Review of Corporate Finance Studies, Journal of Comparative Economics, Financial Review, National Science Foundation's Economics Program, Managerial Finance, Review of Finance, Journal of Housing Economics, Financial Management, Swiss National Science Foundation, Economics Letters, Journal of Finance.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Politics and Finance, Corporate Finance, Machine Learning for Causal Inference.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Valuation, Investments, Machine Learning.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

SYRACUSE UNIVERSITY

Financial Analytics (FIN 454; undergraduate), Spring 2023, 2024, and 2025.

Financial Analytics (FIN 654; graduate), Spring 2023, 2024, and 2025.

Identification and causal inference in corporate finance module (PhD), Fall 2024.

TULANE UNIVERSITY

Investments in Equities (FINE 4110; undergraduate), Spring 2014 and 2015, Fall 2015 and 2016, Spring 2018, 2019, 2020, and 2021.

Identification and causal inference in corporate finance module (PhD), Fall 2016 and 2018.

Valuation & Financing Enterprises, Fall 2013 and 2014 (FINE 7600; MBA and MsF), Spring 2016 (independent study, undergraduate).

UNIVERSITY OF ROCHESTER

Corporate Finance (course instructor; FIN 413; MBA), Summer 2011 and 2012.

Managerial Economics (lab instructor; STR 401; MBA), Fall 2010 and 2011.

Data Analytics (lab instructor; GBA 412; MBA), Spring 2010 and Winter 2011.

MEMBERSHIP

American Finance Association, Western Finance Association, European Finance Association, Econometrics Society.